

Proposal for Emoji: Stomach

Submitter: Shuhan He, MD; David Rhew, MD (Global Chief Medical Officer and Vice President of Healthcare, Microsoft); Heena Purohit (Director of AI Startups, Microsoft for Startups)

Main point of contact: Shuhan He

Date: 2026-07-28

1. Identification

CLDR short name: stomach

CLDR keywords: digestion; gut; belly; abdomen; hunger; appetite; fullness; nausea; indigestion; reflux

Category: People & Body body-parts

Sort location: after Lungs

2. Images

	18x18	72x72
Color		
Black and white		

License: I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the [CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication](#) and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

3. Reference emoji

Nauseated Face, Worried Face, Butterfly, Fork and Knife, Pregnant Man, Pregnant Person, and the mandated comparison term Elephant.

4. Factors for inclusion

a. Multiple meanings

Stomach names the organ and everyday body area. Merriam-Webster also records appetite and the verb meaning to tolerate. Expressions include "butterflies in your stomach," "a strong stomach," "turn my stomach," and being unable to stomach something. Section 7 documents the verb and idioms in published use.

Sources: [Merriam-Webster](#) and [Cambridge Dictionary](#).

b. Use in sequences

Stomach gives existing emoji a precise semantic anchor:

- Stomach + Fork and Knife: fullness or digestion after a meal.
- Stomach + Nauseated Face: an upset stomach.
- Stomach + Butterfly: nervous anticipation, or "butterflies in the stomach."

Without Stomach, the face, utensil, and animal retain unrelated meanings. The proposed character improves existing emoji by making these compositions precise rather than replacing them.

c. Breaks new ground

Yes. No existing emoji names or depicts the stomach. CLDR 48.2 English annotations have no exact match for stomach , digestion , gut , abdomen , or nausea . Related searches fragment across Pregnant Man and Pregnant Person (belly), Nauseated Face (nauseated), faces, foods, and Fork and Knife (hungry), and Worried Face (butterflies). None represents the organ.

The audit is reproducible against Unicode's pinned CLDR 48.2 English annotations. Stomach adds one body-part building block connecting the organ with digestion, appetite, fullness, tolerance, and idioms.

d. Distinctiveness

The image has a J shape, long upper inlet, open inner curve, broad lower body, and short outlet. At 18x18, the J shape and two openings distinguish it from Beans, Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Meat on Bone. The comparison uses nearest-neighbor enlargement to preserve the actual pixels.

	<u>Stomach (proposed)</u>	Beans	Anatomical Heart	Lungs	Meat on Bone
72 x 72					
18 x 18 (enlarged)					

Comparison glyphs: Noto Emoji (open licensed), shown for visual comparison only.

The comparison glyphs are open-licensed Noto Emoji and are not part of the proposed artwork.

e. Usage level

Section 7 supplies the five required empirical measures. Stomach is higher in Google Video Search, the displayed Trends Web average, and recent Books data; elephant is higher in Google Search and most of the Trends Image range. Continuous worldwide and published use supports expected use without claiming pre-encoding emoji usage.

f. Completeness

N/A. Internal organs are not a fixed or closed set.

g. Compatibility

N/A. No high-frequency Stomach pictograph is claimed in Snapchat, X, QQ, a legacy carrier set, or another popular proprietary system. The CLDR search-routing issue above is an interoperability finding, not a claim of pre-existing proprietary emoji compatibility.

5. Counterarguments to factors for exclusion

a. Already representable

Nauseated Face expresses illness or disgust; Fork and Knife expresses eating; Butterfly depicts an animal; Worried Face expresses anxiety; and Pregnant Man or Pregnant Person can express bloating or fullness. None names the organ, and combinations preserve that ambiguity.

b. Overly specific

Stomach is the general organ and body-area concept, not a disease, procedure, brand, or subtype. The noun spans digestion, appetite, fullness, nausea, reflux, tolerance, and idioms.

c. Open-ended

No. The case rests on this noun's independent literal, verbal, and idiomatic range, not an anatomy set. It makes no claim for Liver, Pancreas, Gallbladder, Spleen, or Intestines and requires no further organs.

d. Transient

Stomach is not tied to a product, campaign, or event. Section 7 shows the verb in continuous use since the seventeenth century, durable idioms, and "butterflies in my stomach" rising after 1990.

e. Faulty comparison

This proposal does not depend on the existence of other body-part emoji. Anatomical Heart, Lungs, Beans, and other characters are visual or semantic comparators only; none creates an entitlement to encode Stomach.

6. Other information

Vendors should preserve the J shape, upper inlet, open inner curve, and short outlet while varying color, angle, outline, and shading. Fine anatomical detail should yield to clarity at 18x18.

UTS #51 identifies CLDR annotations as data used to search and group emoji. With no Stomach character, CLDR-based products have no standard target for `stomach` or `digestion`; app-specific images cannot round-trip as one character across products. Encoding Stomach would give vendors a shared unit and annotation target. Products may customize CLDR, so this does not claim every picker returns identical results.

Source: [UTS #51, Unicode Emoji](#).

7. Evidence of frequency

Captures used a private browser window, disabled search personalization, and the widest date range available. Trends used All categories because `stomach` is unambiguous and a health category would distort the required `elephant` comparison. The data are a dated, reproducible snapshot.

Source	stomach	elephant	Finding
Google Search	353,000,000	491,000,000	elephant higher
Google Video Search	139,000,000	86,300,000	stomach higher
Google Trends, Web Search	higher displayed average	lower displayed average	stomach higher
Google Trends, Image Search	lower across most of range	higher across most of range	elephant higher
Google Books Ngram	substantially higher recently	lower recently	stomach higher

Google Search

Captured 2026-07-26 for `stomach` and 2026-07-27 for `elephant` . [Open stomach query](#) and [open elephant query](#).

Google

stomach

×

🔍

🔊

📷

⚙️

🔗

📱

Sign in

AI Mode

All

Images

Shopping

Videos

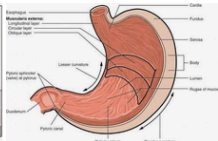
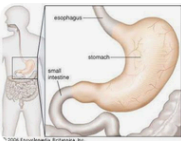
Short videos

Forums

More

Tools

AI Overview



The stomach is a J-shaped muscular organ located in the upper left abdomen that

Any time

All results

Advanced Search

About 353,000,000 results (0.17s)

Stomach anatomy, Function, Diagram, Parts Of, Structure - ...

What is the stomach? The stomach is a J-shaped organ that digests food. It produc...

Cleveland Clinic

Google

elephant

×

🔍

🔊

📷

⚙️

All

Images

Shopping

Videos

News

Short videos

More

Tools

See results about

 Elephants
Animal

Elephant

🔊

Any time

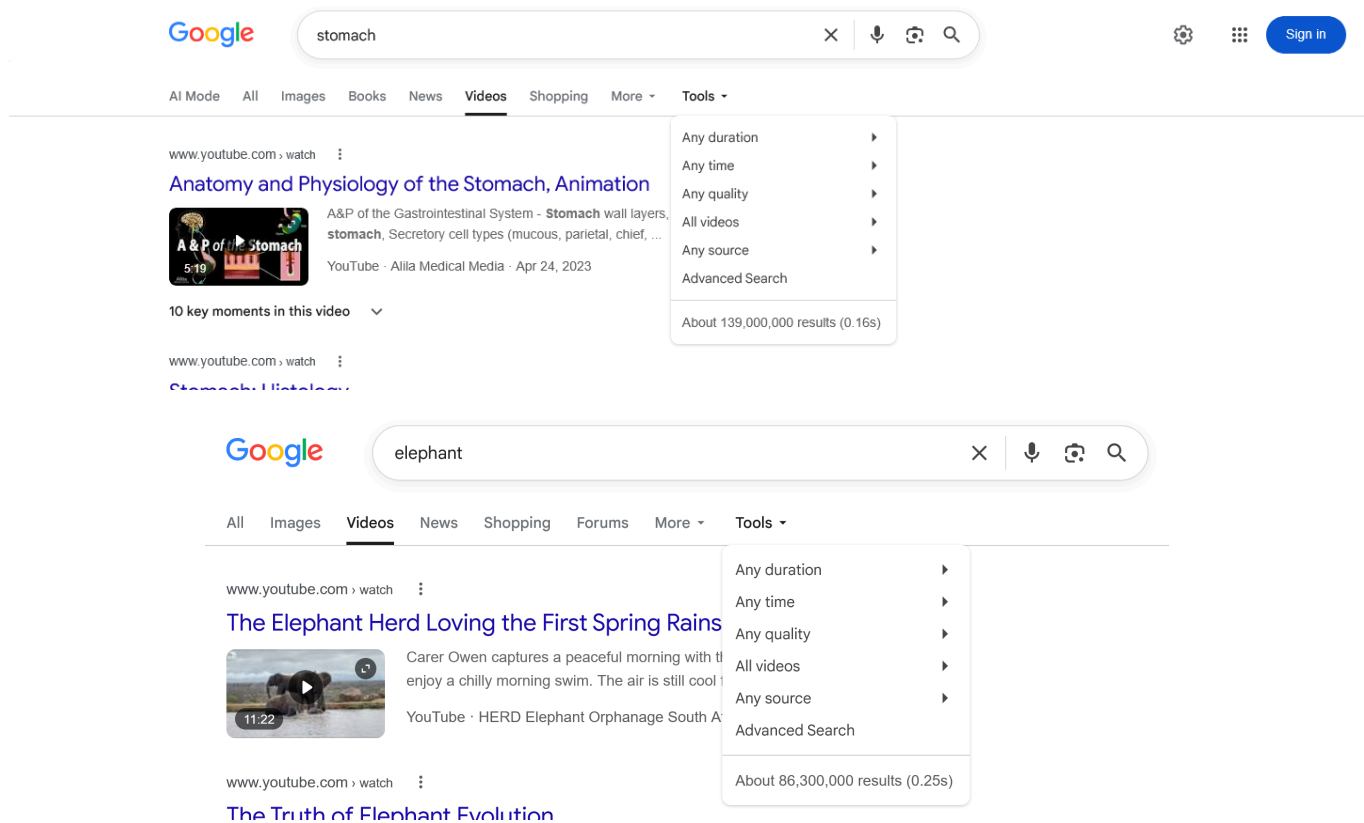
All results

Advanced Search

About 491,000,000 results (0.29s)

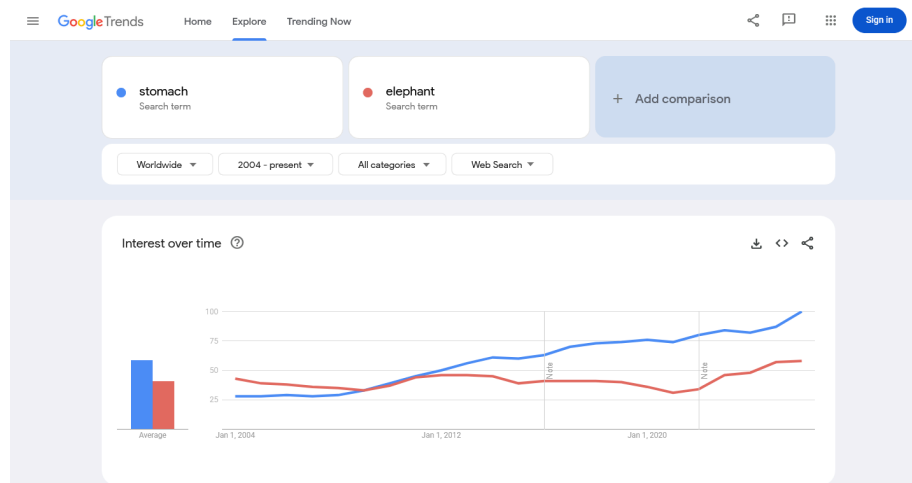
Google Video Search

Captured 2026-07-26 for stomach and 2026-07-27 for elephant . [Open stomach video query](#) and [open elephant video query](#).



Google Trends: Web Search

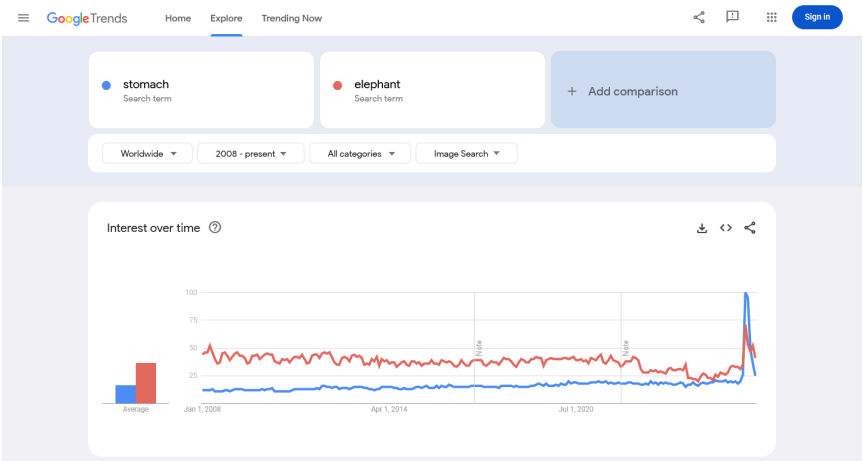
Captured 2026-07-26, Worldwide, 2004-present, All categories. Stomach holds the higher displayed average and the higher line across most of the range. [Open comparison](#).



Google Trends: Image Search

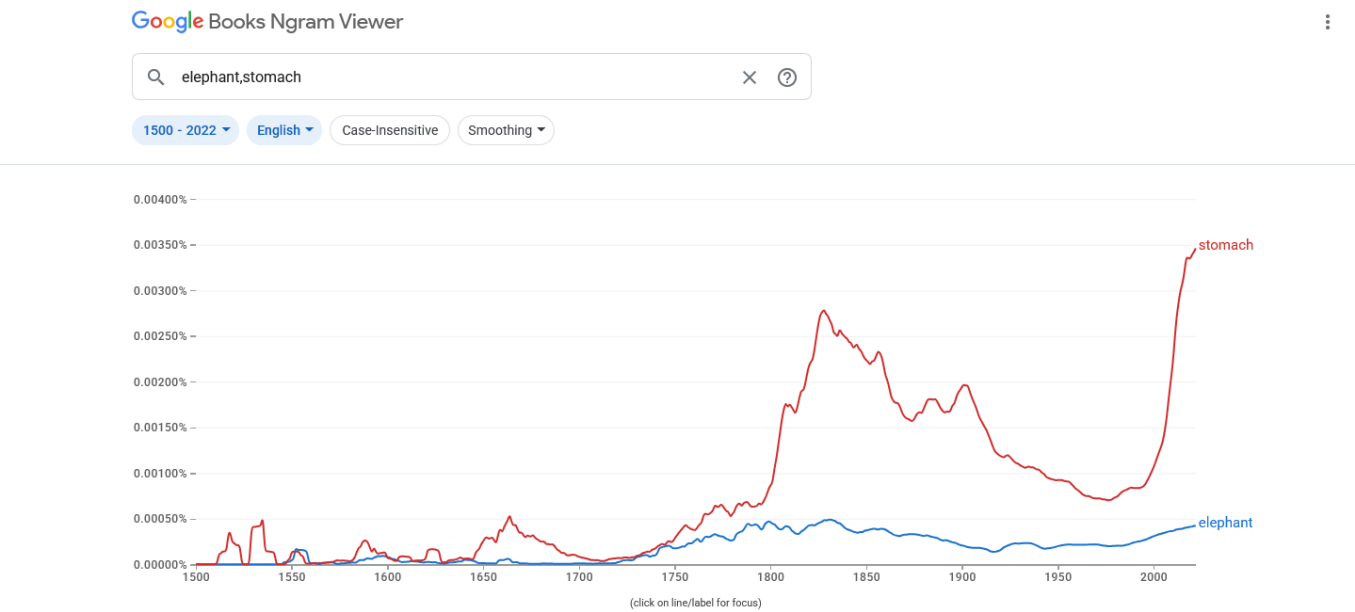
Captured 2026-07-26, Worldwide, 2008-present, All categories. Elephant is higher across most of the range. Stomach rises above elephant only in the most recent period; no weight is placed on that terminal crossover.

[Open comparison.](#)



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-26 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, case-insensitive matching, and smoothing 3. Stomach substantially exceeds elephant in the latest displayed years. [Open comparison.](#)



Supplementary Ngram evidence

Captured 2026-07-27 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. The first exhibit isolates the tagged verb; the second documents three idiomatic phrases.

